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Sulṭān Husayn Mīrzā Khusrau Shah and Other Mīrzās

A brief about Sulṭān Husayn Bayqara Mīrzā

Sulṭān Husayn Bayqara Mīrzā was the Tīmūrid ruler of Herat from AD 1469 to AD 1506, barring some interruption in his reign in AD 1470.[*] He was a skilled statesman and had a keen interest in arts. He was renowned as a benefactor and patron of learning in his kingdom.[†] His reign was popularly known as the second Tīmūrid Renaissance.[‡] He has been described as 'the quintessential Tīmūrid ruler of the later period in Transoxiana'. Even Babur found his sophisticated court and generous artistic patronage as a source of inspiration.[§] One can even say that Sulṭān Husayn Bayqara was the last Tīmūrid ruler of consequence in Khurāsān.[¶]

He was born in Herat to great-grandson of Timur, Ghiyas ud-din Mansur Mīrzā and his wife Firuza Sulṭān Begum in July of AD 1438. Firuza was the daughter of Sulṭān Husayn. He came from the powerful Tayichiud tribe. He also claimed descent in the ninth generation from Khwaja Abdullah Ansari of Herat, also known as Pir-e-Herat.[*]

Ghiyas ud-din Mansur Mīrzā died when Sulṭān Husayn was just eight years old. It is worth noting that he was not a very influential one from the Tīmūrid family. Hence Sulṭān Husayn adopted the name Bayqara after his more illustrious grandfather, Bayqara Mīrzā I.[†] His mother suggested that he join the service of his older cousin Abul-Qasim Babur Mīrzā, who was the ruler of Herat in AD 1452.